



# Prologue — First Shift at Phantom Q

From routine onboarding to the first unresolved security incident



- ★ What this establishes
- Identity and authentication
- Routine communication workflow
- First evidence of a security anomaly
- Clear reason to enter Foundations



The Prologue begins as an ordinary first shift and gradually becomes a cybersecurity incident.



# Scene 1 — Arrival at Phantom Q Headquarters

The learner's first view of Headquarters, its key facilities and the initial path into the organisation



What this scene establishes



First orientation  
inside Headquarters



Visible but restricted  
specialist facilities



Entrance → Reception →  
Central Operations path



Location as part of the  
game experience



The first scene introduces Headquarters as a readable security world rather than a menu.



# Scene 2 — Create Your Phantom Q Identity

The learner registers through Reception / ID and creates the fictional training credential used throughout the Prologue



## Create Your Phantom Q Identity

Complete your details to create your training credential.

Operator name / callsign

A. Mthembu

Username

amthembu.training

Training password

.....



Confirm password

.....



Create a fictional training password.  
Do not reuse a real password.

Create identity



What this scene establishes



Reception as the onboarding point



Identity creation inside the game world



World layer + device layer interaction



Training credential persists into later scenes



The learner's identity is created inside Headquarters, not through an abstract menu.



# Scene 3 — Eve's Adversarial Credential Check

The newly created training password is assessed through an authorised Red-Team security review



What this scene establishes



Eve enters as an authorised Red-Team capability



Password strength becomes a gameplay choice



Security review happens inside the story



The learner's decision persists forward



Eve is introduced through evidence-based security testing, not as an obvious villain.



# Scene 4 — Trainee Clearance Issued

The learner receives a Phantom Q ID and sees which Headquarters areas are open or restricted



**PHANTOM Q ENGINEERS — TRAINEE ID**



|              |            |
|--------------|------------|
| Operator:    | A. Mthembu |
| Status:      | ACTIVE     |
| Clearance:   | TRAINEE    |
| Workstation: | 04         |

**ACCESS GRANTED:**

- ✓ Central Operations
- ✓ Training
- ✓ Communications

**RESTRICTED:**

- 🔒 Cryptography Lab
- 🔒 Red-Team Laboratory
- 🔒 SOC
- 🔒 Engineering Workshop
- 🔒 Quantum Wing
- 🔒 Advanced Compute
- 🔒 Secure Core



What this scene establishes



Clearance becomes visible



Some rooms open, others remain restricted



The badge becomes a persistent identity object



The next destination is Central Operations



Clearance is introduced as something the learner can see, carry and encounter at doors.



# Scene 5 – Login to Your Workstation

The trainee moves from Reception / ID to Central Operations and uses the credential created earlier



PHANTOM Q WORKSTATION 04

Username

amthembu.training

Password

.....

LOGIN

✓ IDENTITY VERIFIED  
Clearance: **TRAINEE**

AVAILABLE APPLICATIONS

|                  |             |
|------------------|-------------|
| Communications   | Training    |
| Profile / Access | SOC Console |
| Quantum Systems  |             |

- ★ What this scene establishes
- The earlier credential is now used
- Authentication happens before operation
- Central Operations becomes the player anchor
- Locked systems remain visible but unavailable



The workstation turns identity into action: the learner can now operate inside the Headquarters system.



# Scene 6 — Routine Transfer Request

Alice physically brings the files while Bob confirms he is ready on the receiving side



What this scene establishes



Alice is the file source



Bob is the receiving side



The trainee operates the transfer



The USB becomes a persistent evidence object



Alice and Bob are introduced through their responsibilities, not through a disconnected character biography.



# Scene 7 — Establishing Normal Behaviour

The first file transfer shows what a successful communication should look like before any anomaly appears



ACTIVITY HISTORY



01\_LAYOUT.PNG

— DELIVERED ✓



What this scene establishes



Normal send /  
receive workflow



Sender, operator and  
receiver roles are clear



File identity  
is visible



Successful delivery  
becomes the baseline



The learner must first see normal behaviour before suspicious behaviour has meaning.



# Scene 8 — Normal Transfer Confirmed

The second successful transfer reinforces the expected communication pattern before anything goes wrong



ACTIVITY HISTORY



01\_LAYOUT.PNG



DELIVERED ✓



02\_REPORT.PDF



DELIVERED ✓



What this scene establishes



Normal send / receive pattern repeats successfully



The learner now expects the transfer process to be reliable



Sender, operator and receiver roles remain clear



Two successful files create a clear baseline for the anomaly that follows



Repetition establishes expected behaviour; the learner now has a reliable baseline against which the third transfer can be judged.



# Scene 9 — The Forgotten Third File

Alice returns with one more file Bob still needs — an ordinary human oversight, not yet a cyber incident



ACTIVITY HISTORY



01\_LAYOUT.PNG



DELIVERED ✓



A believable workplace mistake sets up the next event without prematurely blaming an attacker.



What this scene establishes



Human mistakes can create operational risk without malicious intent



The third file becomes the new variable in an otherwise normal workflow



Alice remains the confirmed source of the file



The learner sees the next action before any attack is assumed



# Scene 10 — The First Real Anomaly

The trainee sends the third file, but Bob reports that it never reached him



What this scene establishes



The trainee and Bob now see contradictory states



Availability becomes the first security property directly affected



The normal baseline is no longer reliable



ACTIVITY HISTORY



01\_LAYOUT.PNG



DELIVERED ✓



02\_REPORT.PDF



DELIVERED ✓



03\_ACCESS\_SCHEDULE.XLSX



SENT ✓ / DELIVERY ?

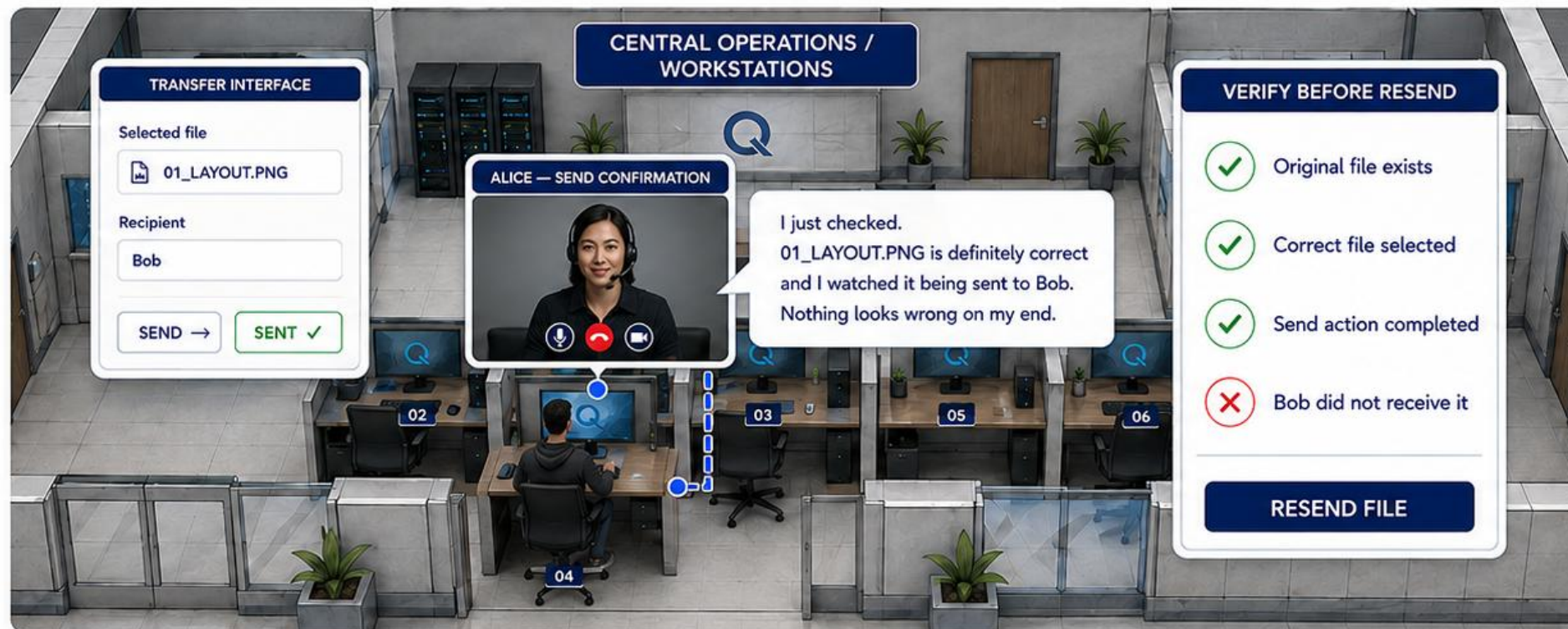


The first real anomaly is simple and understandable: the system says the file was sent, but the intended recipient does not have it.



# Scene 11 — Verify, Then Retry

The trainee checks the simple explanation with Alice before escalating the situation



What this scene establishes



The learner verifies evidence before assuming an attack



Alice confirms the original file and the send action



The retry becomes a deliberate troubleshooting step, not a random repetition



Good security reasoning starts by checking the simple explanations first; escalation comes only after the facts stop matching.



# Scene 12 – File Arrives Changed

Bob receives the resent file, but it is different from Alice's original

**ORIGINAL – ALICE**

**03\_ACCESS\_SCHEDULE.XLSX**

Access Level:  
**LAB 2**

Sent by Alice  
14:28:11 UTC

**RECEIVED – BOB**

**03\_ACCESS\_SCHEDULE.XLSX**

Access Level:  
**LAB 4**

Received by Bob  
14:33:52 UTC

**Alice**  
Originating  
(On Call)

**Bob**  
Receiving  
(On Call)

I have it now,  
but this isn't what  
I was expecting.

## What this scene establishes

- The delivery issue has escalated
- Integrity is now affected
- Confidentiality must be questioned



**03\_ACCESS\_SCHEDULE.XLSX** — **RECEIVED** ✓ — **MATCH** ✗



The incident is no longer only about delivery; the received information no longer matches the original.



# Scene 13 — Credential Anomaly & Eve Check

The password created at registration becomes relevant when account activity no longer matches the trainee's actions



## What this scene establishes

- The learner's credential is now evidence
- Suspicious activity is not proof of guilt
- Authorised testing must be checked



USER: AMTHEMBU.TRAINING — CURRENT SESSION ✓ — UNKNOWN SESSION ⚠



The investigation widens from file transfer failure to identity, access and authorisation.



# Scene 14 — Incident PQ-001 Created

The SOC records the unresolved evidence, but the trainee does not yet have clearance to investigate fully



## INCIDENT PQ-001



### EVIDENCE

First two transfers normal



Third file initially unavailable



Resent file altered



Unknown account session



No authorised Red-Team test active



Cause: **UNKNOWN**



## What this scene establishes



Evidence is gathered before blame



SOC becomes active but restricted



The incident has no confirmed cause yet



PQ-001 — STATUS: **ACTIVE** — CAUSE: **UNKNOWN** — SOC ACCESS: **RESTRICTED**



The system opens an investigation without pretending that the attacker is already known.



# Scene 15 — Mission 01 Unlocked

The unresolved incident gives the learner a reason to enter Foundations



## What this scene establishes

- Learning is driven by the incident
- Foundations unlocks for a clear reason
- Higher-security areas remain visible but restricted



### MISSION 01 — Understand the Incident

Required Capabilities:



Information Security



Identity



Access



Trust



Basic Protection

HQ Status:



Incident Active



FOUNDATIONS LAB — ACCESS GRANTED ✓



SOC — RESTRICTED ⚠



QUANTUM WING — LOCKED ⚡



The learner enters Foundations because the unresolved incident now demands basic security understanding.